

Take Away English 随身英语

Programmes for those not watching

给不看屏幕的人设计的电视节目

词汇: TV drama 电视剧

- 1 OK, I'm not proud of it, but sometimes when I'm watching TV, I might not actually be watching. Sometimes I'm just more **tempted** by my phone. Be honest, do you do the same? If you do, then we're not alone, lots of us watch TV with our phones in our hands. How is TV changing to accommodate this?
- 2 Let's start by looking at the data. Studies have investigated different countries across the world and many of them reported that most people use their phone while watching TV. While the classic stereotype is that it's younger people who find it hard to put their phone down, the data actually shows that **second-screening** is common in most age groups under 55. Younger age groups are more likely to be looking at social media or food delivery apps, while older age groups prefer banking, e-commerce and travel.
- 3 How are producers dealing with this? A number of **screenwriters** have reported being told that they need to make programmes easier to follow for **distracted viewers**. Reports say that **showrunners** have asked for more **exposition** in **dialogue**, repetition of **plot points** and increased use of **voice-over** to make things clearer for those who aren't looking. Some **critics** and viewers have complained that this could be making series less complex and dialogue less natural.
- 4 Second screens are not the only reason that these things happen. Television drama writing developed from radio drama writing, which has to use dialogue to compensate for the lack of **visuals**. When books are **adapted** for TV or film, one challenge is how to tell the whole story with less **narration**. All this means that exposition has often been a feature of TV writing. As series became more **prestigious** and **cinematic** since the early 2000s, this clear **signposting** of plot points had become less common.
- 5 Of course, TV viewers and TV programmes are not all the same. There is space for both casual and more complex programmes. Maybe the most important thing is for us to remember when to put our phones down.

测验与练习

一、将标题和段落配对。

Paragraph 1 _____

Paragraph 2 _____

Paragraph 3 _____

Paragraph 4 _____

Paragraph 5 _____

- a. Exposition on screen
- b. A widespread trend
- c. Changes in the programmes we watch
- d. Films on our phone
- e. Should we take control?
- f. Do you second screen?

二、根据文章内容选出正确的选项。

1. A majority of people surveyed use a second screen while they watch TV.
 - a. True
 - b. False
 - c. Not given
2. Older people prefer to order takeaway food while they watch.
 - a. True
 - b. False
 - c. Not given
3. What does 'this' refer to in the following sentence? *Some critics and viewers have complained that **this** could be making series less complex and dialogue less natural.*
 - a. viewers asking for changes
 - b. showrunners asking for changes
 - c. distracted viewers
4. Books and films tell stories in the same way.
 - a. True
 - b. False
 - c. Not given

5. TV stories became less clear in the early 2000s.
- a. True
 - b. False
 - c. Not given

三、用方框中的单词完成对本文的总结。

Many of us are **1)** _____ while we watch the latest series. It's not just the youngest generations that are **2)** _____ by their phones; most people under 55 do this while watching TV. **3)** _____ say that they have been asked to change scripts. **4)** _____ have asked them to make plots easier to follow for distracted viewers. Many series now have more direct **5)** _____ in dialogue, as well as more use of repetition and voice-overs.

dialogue	tempted	showrunners
scriptwriters		exposition
adapted		second screening

（答案见词汇表后）

词汇表

tempt	诱惑，引诱
second-screening	第二屏幕，看电视、电影等主屏幕的同时浏览手机、平板电脑等“第二设备”
screenwriter	编剧
distracted	分心的，注意力分散的
viewer	观众
showrunner	（节目）制作人
exposition	详细阐释，清楚的解释
dialogue	对白，对话
plot point	情节转折点
voice-over	画外音，配音
critic	评论家，批评家
visual	视觉画面，视觉效果
adapt	改编
narration	解说，旁白
prestigious	精品化的
cinematic	电影般的
signposting	指引，标注

答案

一、将标题和段落配对。

Paragraph 1 **f) Do you second screen?**

Paragraph 2 **b) A widespread trend**

Paragraph 3 **c) Changes in the programmes we watch**

Paragraph 4 **a) Exposition on screen**

Paragraph 5 **e) Should we take control?**

二、根据文章内容选出正确的选项。

1. **a. True.** *Studies have investigated different countries across the world and many of them reported that **most people** use their phone while watching TV.*
2. **b. False.** *Younger age groups are more likely to be looking at social media or food delivery apps, while **older age groups prefer banking, e-commerce and travel.***
3. **b.** *'This' in that sentence refers back to showrunners asking for more exposition, repetition and use of voice-over.*
4. **b. False.** *When books are adapted for TV or film, one challenge is how to **tell the whole story with less narration.***
5. **a. True.** *As series became more prestigious and cinematic since the early 2000s, this **clear signposting of plot points had become less common.***

三、用方框中的单词完成对本文的总结。

Many of us are **second screening** while we watch the latest series. It's not just the youngest generations that are **tempted** by their phones; most people under 55 do this while watching TV. **Screenwriters** say that they have been asked to change scripts. **Showrunners** have asked them to make plots easier to follow for distracted viewers. Many series now have more direct **exposition** in dialogue, as well as more use of repetition and voice-overs.